



Class 9 2022-23

PHYSICAL FEATURES OF INDIA

Ch 2 | Class 9 S.St. (Geography)

Handwritten Notes & Imp Questions



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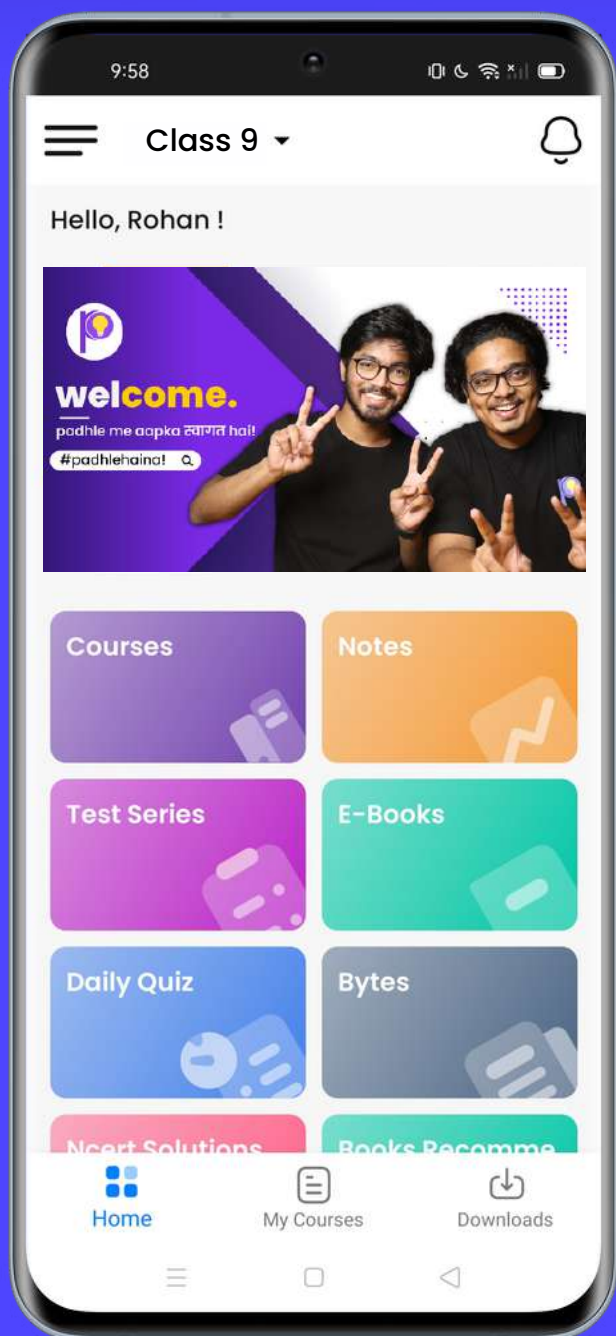
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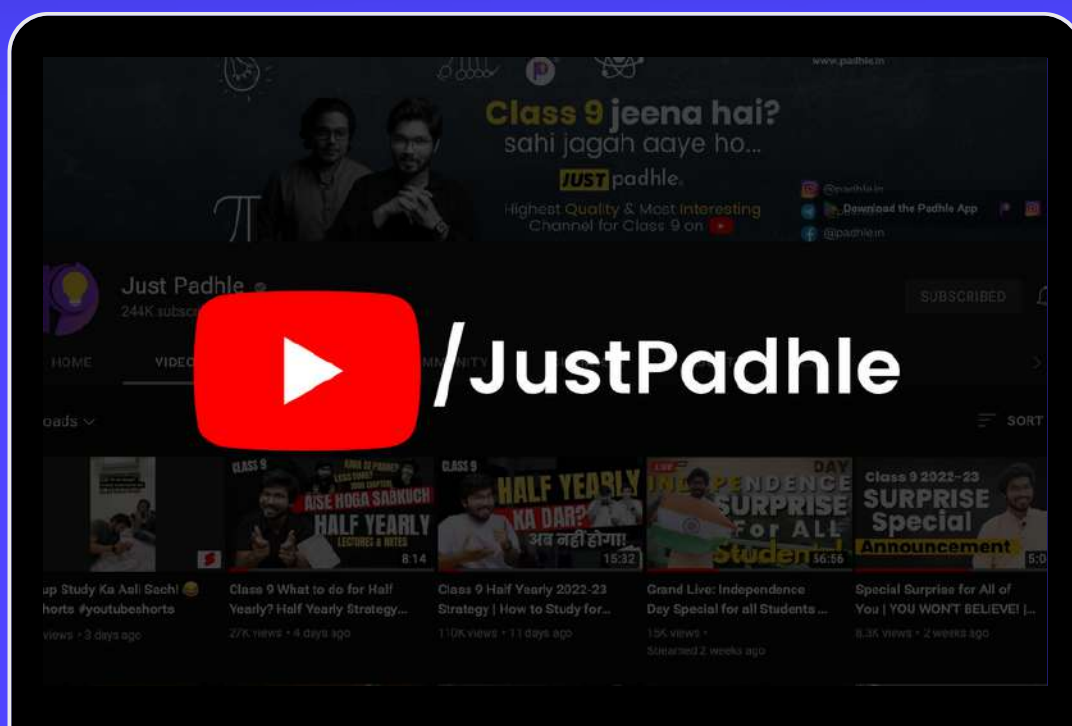
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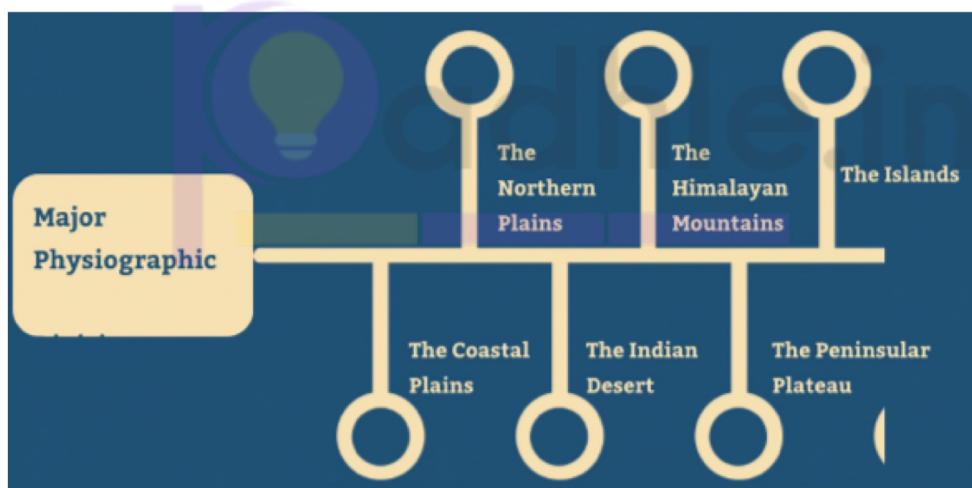
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PHYSICAL FEATURES OF INDIA

- If you live in the plains, you are familiar with the vast stretches of plain land.
- In contrast, if you live in hilly region, the rugged terrain with mountains and valleys are common features.
- In fact, our country has practically all major physical features of the earth, i.e., mountains, plains, deserts, plateaus and islands.



* The Himalayan Mountains

→ Basic Features

- Geologically young
- Structurally fold mountains
- Stretch over the northern borders of India.

- Mountain ranges run in a west-east direction from the Indus to the Brahmaputra.
- The Himalayas represent the loftiest and one of the most rugged mountain barriers of the world.



- The Himalayas consists of three parallel ranges in their longitudinal extent.
 - A number of valleys lie between these ranges.

→ The Great or Inner Himalayas or the Himadri

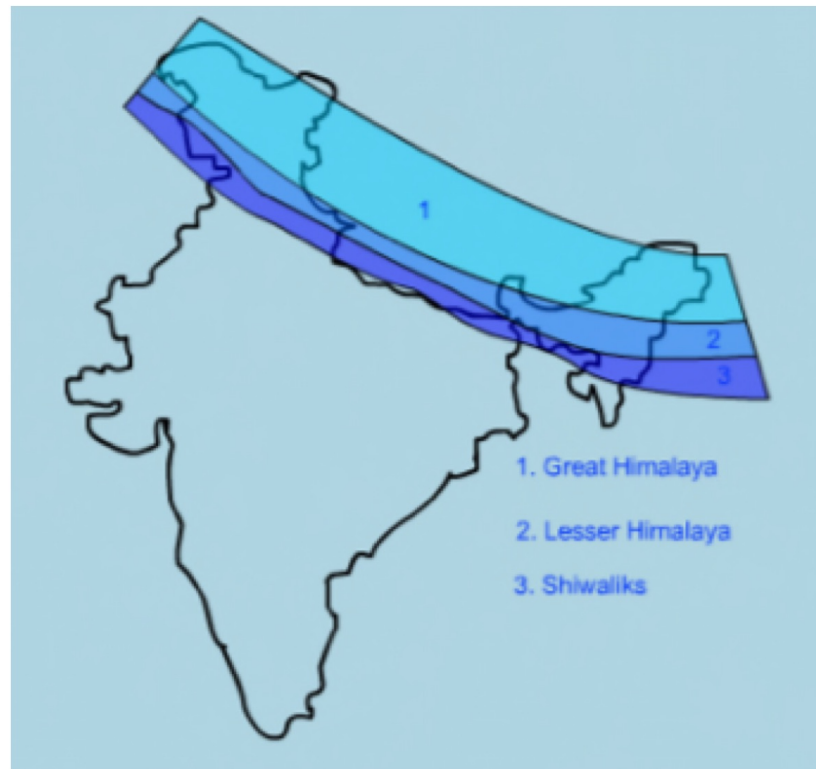
- THE NORTHERN-MOST RANGE.
- It is the most continuous range.
- Consists of the loftiest peaks with an average height of 6,000 metres.

- It contains all prominent Himalayan peaks.
- The folds of the Great Himalayan peaks.
- The core of this part of the Himalayas is composed of **granite**.
- A number of glaciers descend from this range.



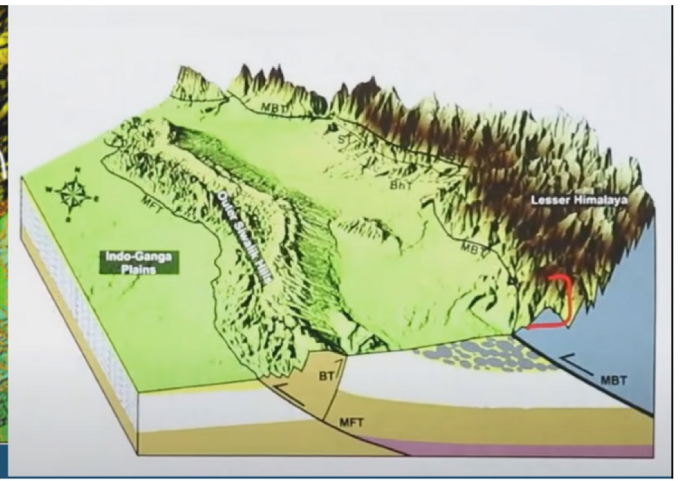
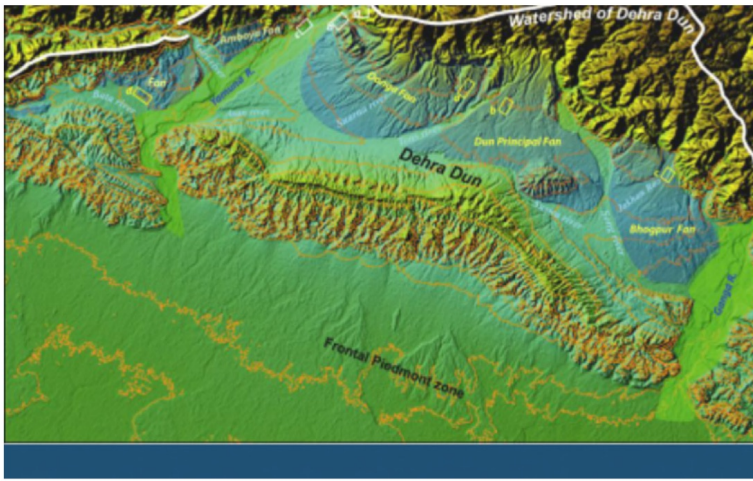
* Himachal or Lesser Himalaya

- The range lies to the **South of the Himadri**.
- Forms the most rugged mountain system.
- The ranges are mainly composed of **highly compressed and altered rocks**.
- The **altitude varies between 3,700 - 4,500 metres** and the **average width is 50 km**.
- Pir Pinjal range forms the longest and the most important range, the Dhauladhar and the Mahabharat ranges are also prominent ones.

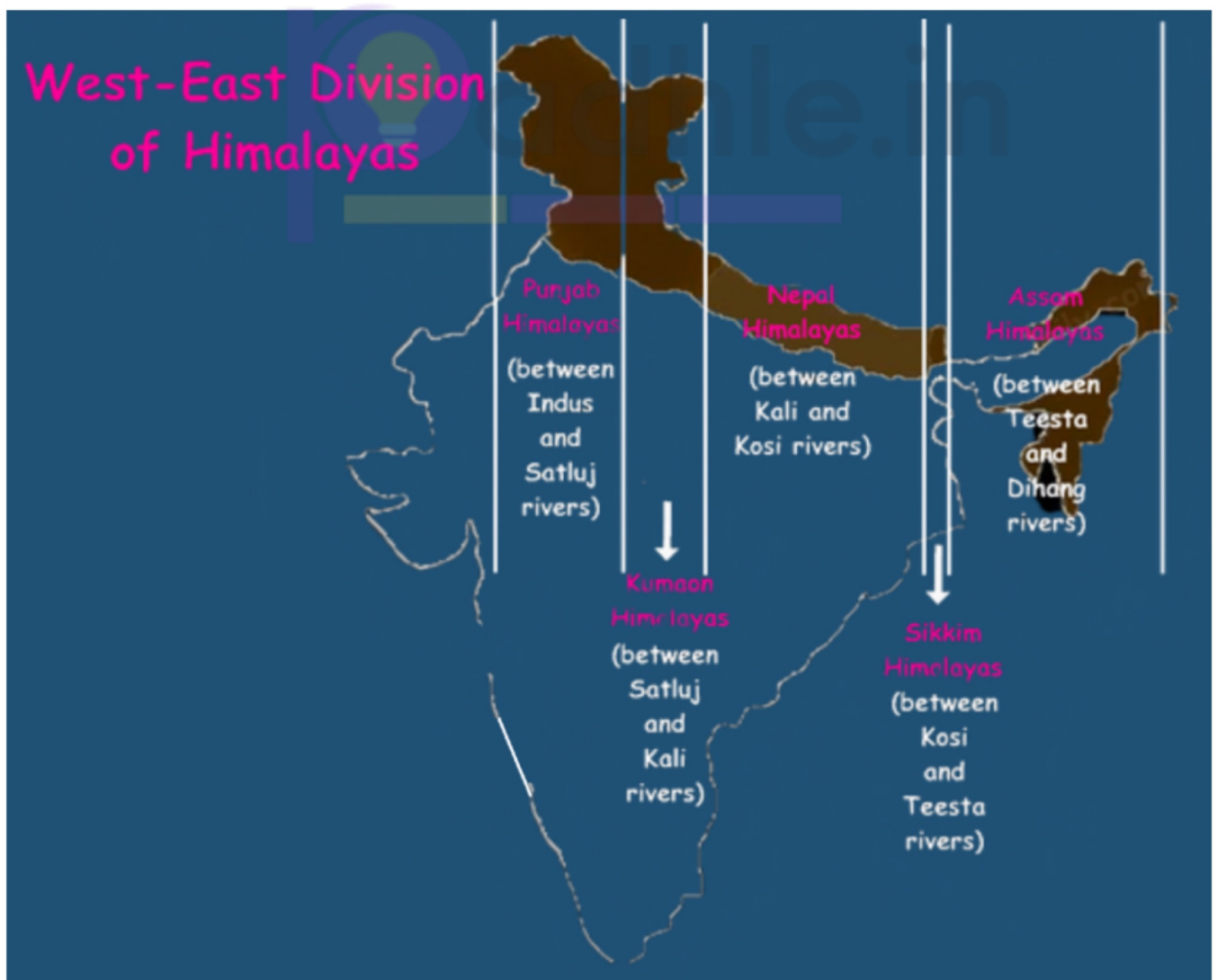


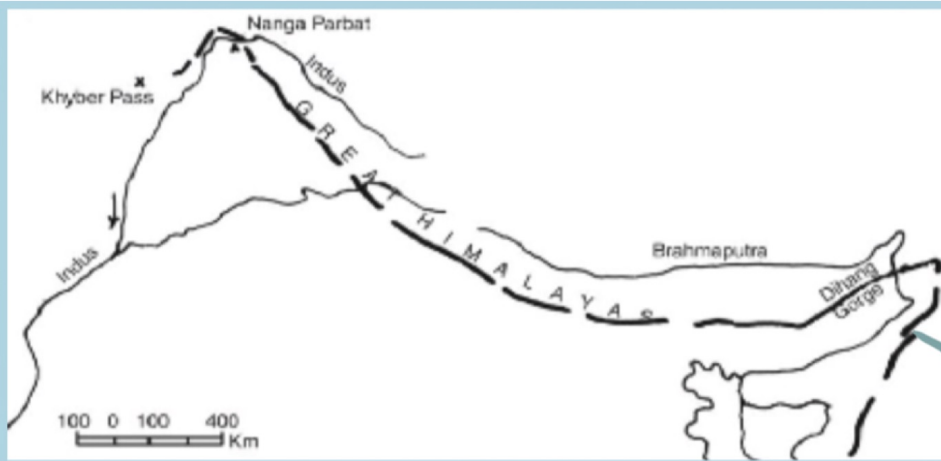
* Shiwaliks

- ▶ They extend over a width of 10-50 km.
- ▶ Have an altitude varying between 900 and 1100 metres.
- ▶ These ranges are composed of unconsolidated sediments brought down by rivers from the main Himalayan ranges located farther north.
- ▶ These valleys are covered with thick gravel and alluvium.
- ▶ The longitudinal valley lying between lesser Himalayas and the Shiwaliks are known as DUNS.
- ▶ Dehra Dun, Kotli Dun and Patli Dun are some of the well-known Duns.



- Besides the longitudinal divisions, the Himalayas have been divided on the basis of regions from west to east.
- These divisions have been demarcated by river valleys.





PURVACHAL OR THE EASTERN HILLS AND MOUNTAINS

- ▶ The Brahmaputra marks the eastern-most boundary of the Himalayas.
 - Beyond the Dihang gorge, the Himalayas bend sharply to the south and spread along the eastern boundary of India.
 - They are known as the Purvachal.
- ▶ These hills running through the north-eastern states are mostly composed of strong sandstones, which are sedimentary rocks.
- ▶ Covered with dense forests, they mostly run as parallel ranges and valleys.
- ▶ The Purvachal comprises the Patkai hills, the Naga hills, the Manipur hills and the Mizo hills.



Figure 2.4 : Mizo Hills

* Northern Plains

- ▶ The northern plain has been formed by the interplay of the three major river systems, namely –
 - the Indus
 - the Ganga
 - the Brahmaputra along with their tributaries.
- ▶ This plain is formed of alluvial soil.
- ▶ The deposition of alluvium in a vast basin lying at the foothills of the Himalayas over millions of years formed this fertile plain.
- ▶ It spreads over an area of 7 lakh sq.km.
 - The plain is about 2400 km long and

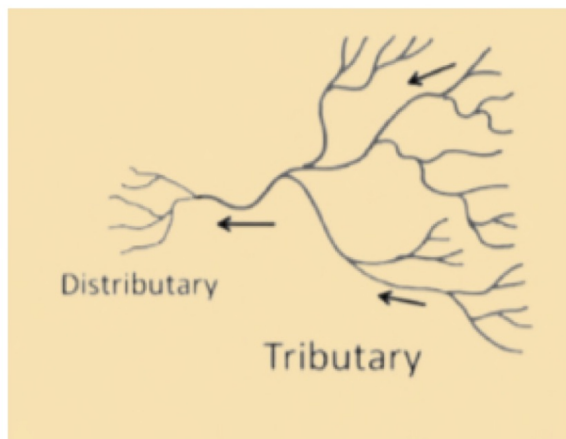
240 - 320 km broad.

- ▶ They are densely populated.
- ▶ With a rich soil cover combined with adequate water supply and favourable climate it is agriculturally a productive part of India.

* Riverine Islands

- ▶ The rivers coming from northern mountains are involved in depositional work.
- ▶ In the lower course, due to the gentle slope, the velocity of the river decreases which results in the formation of riverine islands.
- ▶ Majuli, in the Brahmaputra River is the largest inhabited riverine island in the world.

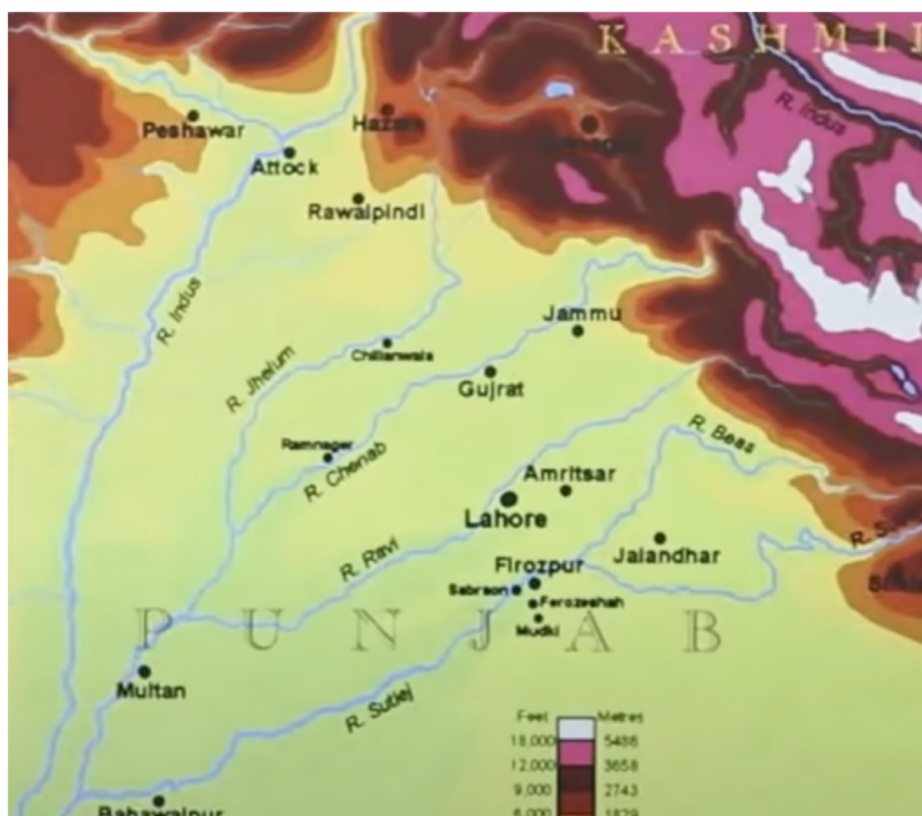
* Tributaries and Distributaries



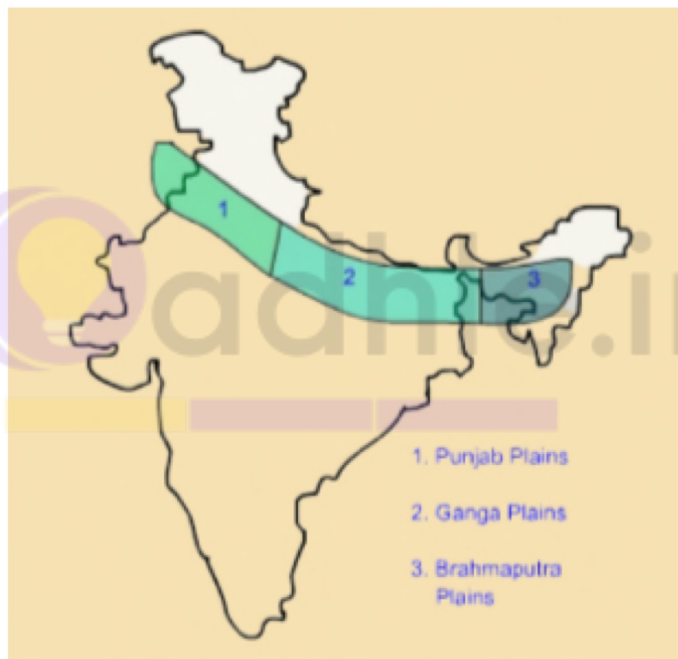
Tributaries	Distributaries
When a small river joins the large or main river, it is called tributary.	When a large river breaks into small rivers, it is called distributary.
These are formed in mountains from glaciers, lakes etc.	Distributary is formed by a large river.
This occurs in the young age of the river.	This occurs in old age of river.
It does not change the course of the river.	It changes the course of the river and often forms a delta.
Example- Yamuna, Ghandak, Kosi, Ghaghara etc. are tributaries of the Ganga.	Example- Sunderbans delta which is formed by distributaries of Ganga and Brahmaputra.

★ Doabs

- ▶ It is the land between the 2 rivers.
- ▶ 'Doab' is made up of two words – 'do' meaning two and 'ab' meaning water.



* Types of Northern Plains



* Indus Plains

- Also known as Punjab Plain, formed by Indus and its tributaries.
- The larger part of this plain lies in Pakistan.
- This section of the plain is dominated by the doabs.

* Ganga Plains

- ▶ Extends between Ghaggar and Teesta rivers.
- ▶ It spread over the state of Haryana, Delhi, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, partly in Jharkhand and West Bengal.

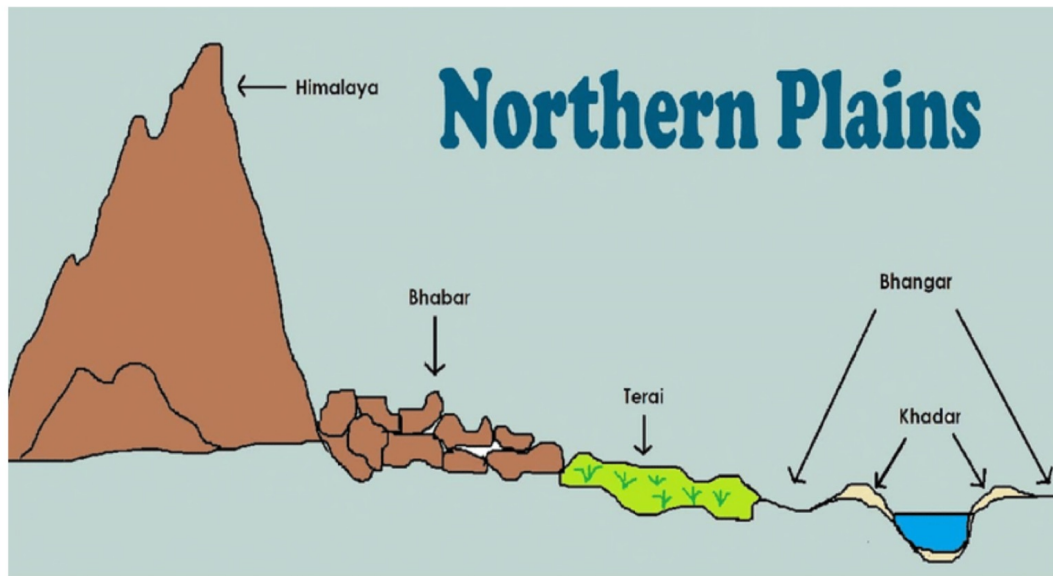
* Brahmaputra Plains

- ▶ East to the Ganga plains lies the Brahmaputra plain.
- ▶ Covers most of the Assam and states of North-east.
- ▶ Drained by Brahmaputra river.
- ▶ The northern plains are generally described as flat land with no variation in its relief.

IT IS NOT TRUE

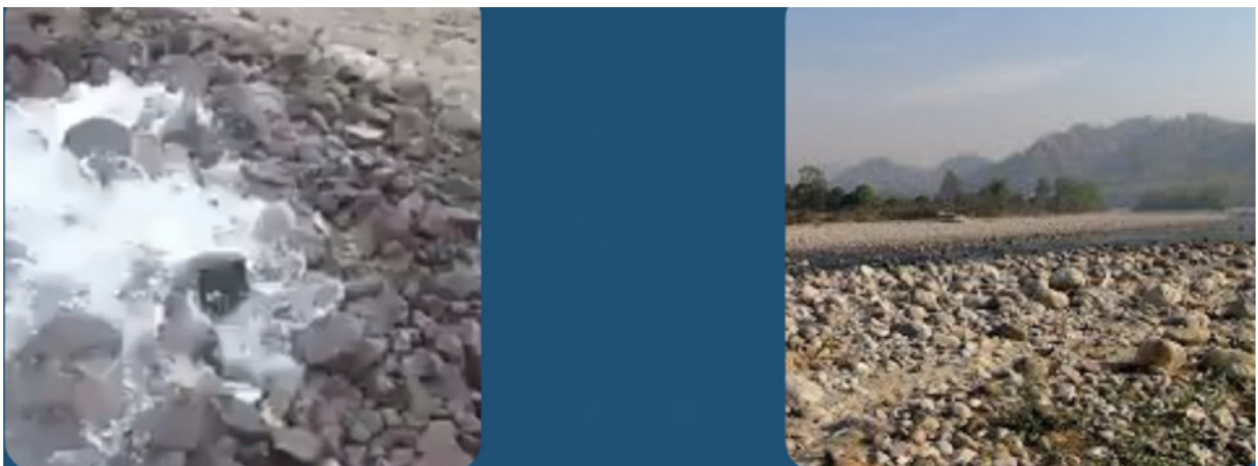
- ▶ These vast plains also have diverse relief features.
- ▶ According to the variations in relief features, the Northern plains can be divided into four regions.

BHABAR TERAI BHANGAR KHADAR



→ Bhabar

- Belt of about 8-16 KM in width line parallel to the slope of Shivaliks.
- The Bhabar area is comprised of pebbles which are brought down by river.
- Streams disappear in the Bhabar belt.



* Terai

- South of this belt, the streams and rivers re-emerge and create a wet, swampy and marshy region known as terai.
- This was a thickly forested region full of wildlife.
- The forests have been cleared to create agricultural land and to settle migrants from Pakistan after partition.

* Bhangar

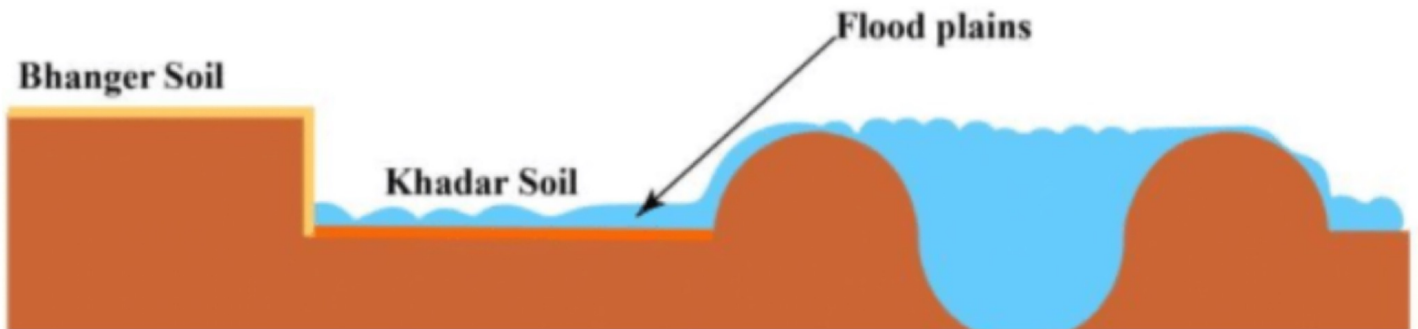
- The largest part of the northern plain is formed of older alluvium.
- It lies above the floodplains of the rivers and presents a terrace-like feature.
- This part is known as bhangar.
- The soil in this region contains calcareous deposits, locally known as kankar.

* Khadar

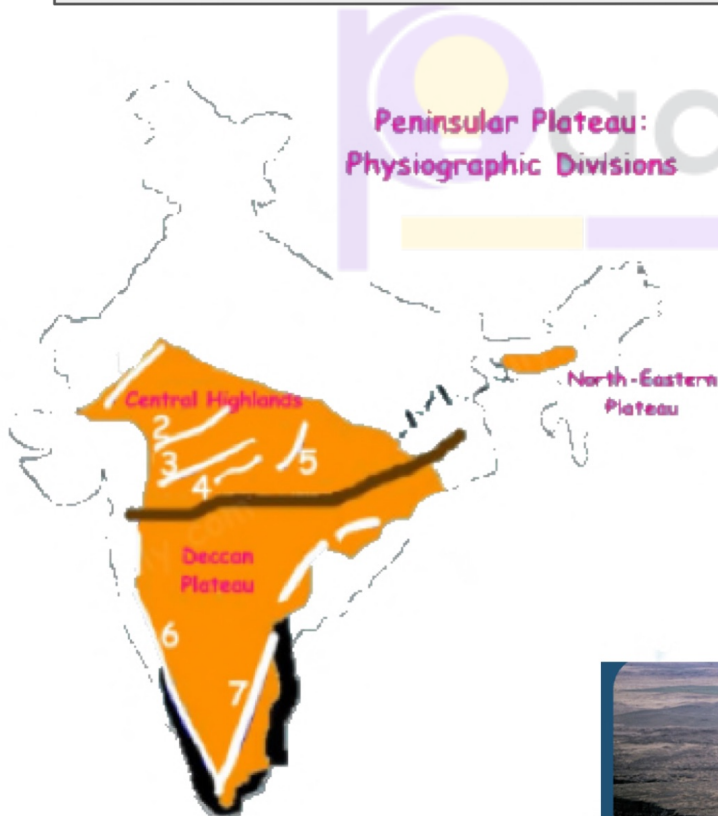
- The newer, younger deposits of the floodplains are called

khadar.

- They are renewed almost every year and so are fertile, thus, ideal for intensive agriculture.



* Peninsular Plateau



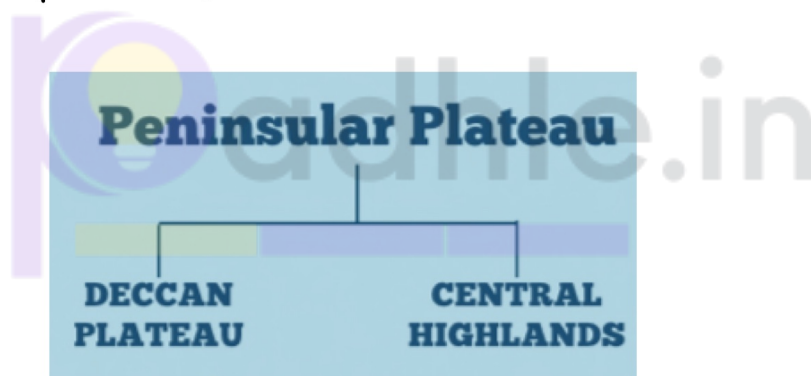
- Peninsular means a landmass covered by water from 3 sides.



It means a tableland like structure

* The Peninsular Plateau

- ▶ The Peninsular plateau is a tableland composed of the old crystalline, igneous and metamorphic rocks.
- ▶ It was formed due to the breaking and drifting of the Gondwana land.
- ▶ The Peninsular plateau is made up of the black soil.
- ▶ Thus, it is a part of the oldest landmass.



* Central Highlands

- ▶ The part of the Peninsular plateau lies north of the Narmada river.
- ▶ Cover a significant area of the Malwa plateau.
- ▶ Covered by Vindhya at the North, Saputara in the South and Aravalis in the Northwest.

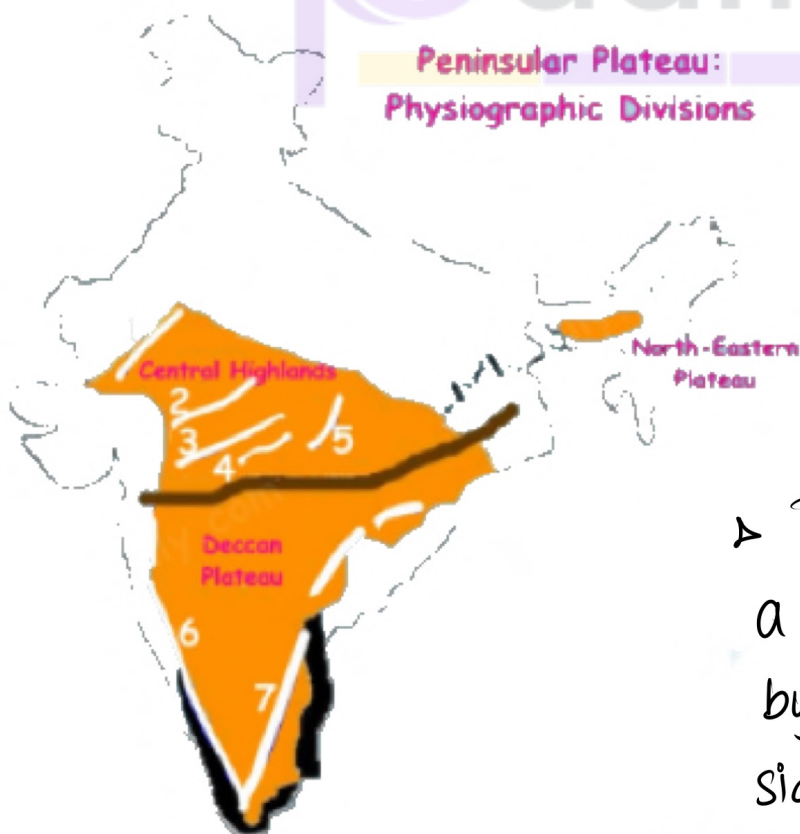
- ▶ Rivers such as the Chambal, the Sindh, the Betwa and the Ken flow from the Southwest to the Southeast. (Indicating the slope)
- ▶ The central Highland are more comprehensive in the West but narrower in the East known as Bundelkhand and Baghelkhand.
- ▶ Chotanagpur plateau marks the further eastward extension.



* Deccan Plateau

- ▶ The Deccan Plateau is a triangular landmass that lies to the south of the river Narmada.

- ▶ Saputara = Northern borders
- ▶ Mahadev, Kaimur hills and Maikal range = Eastern borders.
- ▶ The Deccan Plateau is higher in the west and slopes gently eastwards.
- ▶ An extension of the Plateau is also visible in the northeast, locally known as the Meghalaya, Karbi-Anglon Plateau and North Cachar Hills.
- ▶ Three prominent hill ranges from the west to the east are the Garo, the Khasi and the Jaintia Hills.



- ▶ Peninsular means a landmass covered by water from 3 sides.

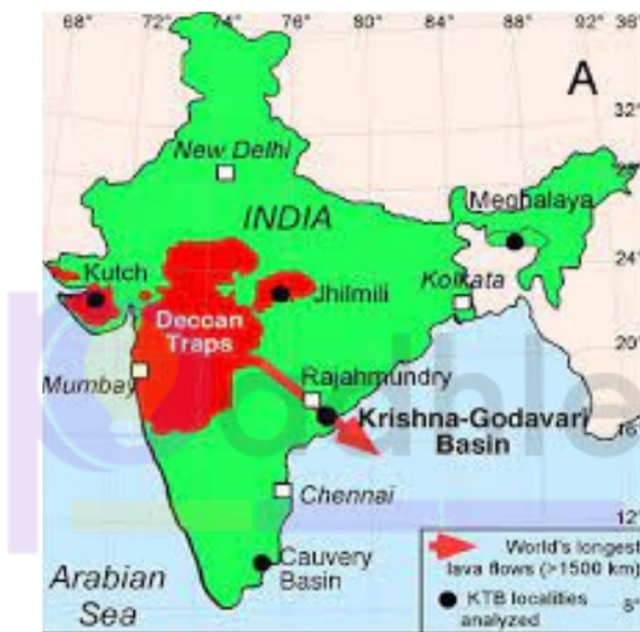
* The Eastern Ghats and The Western Ghats

The Western Ghats	The Eastern Ghats
The Western Ghats lie on the western margin of the Deccan Plateau.	The Eastern Ghats lie on the eastern margin of the Deccan Plateau.
The Western Ghats are higher in elevation. Their average elevation is from 900 to 1600 metres.	The Eastern Ghats are lower in elevation. Their average elevation is 600 metres.
They have a continuous chain of mountains and can be crossed through passes only.	The mountain chains are not continuous and are denuded by the rivers which flow into the Bay of Bengal.
No major river has cut across them.	They have been cut across by major rivers like the Godavari, Mahanadi, Krishna and Kaveri.
THE HIGHEST PEAKS INCLUDE THE ANAI MUDI (2,695 METRES)	MAHENDRAGIRI (1,501 METRES) IS THE HIGHEST PEAK

* Deccan Trap

- The black soil area in the peninsular plateau is called the Deccan Trap.
- This is formed due to continuous flow of lava, so the rocks are igneous.

- ▶ These rocks have been denuded over time and are responsible for the formation of the black soil.
- ▶ The Aravalis lie on the western and north-western margins of the peninsular plateau.
- ▶ These are highly eroded hills and are found as broken hills.



* The Indian Desert

- ▶ The Indian desert lies towards the western margins of the Aravali hills.
- ▶ It is an undulating sandy plain covered with sand dunes.



- ▶ This region receives very low rainfall below 150mm per year.
- ▶ It has an arid climate with low vegetation cover.
- ▶ Streams appear during the rainy season.
- ▶ Soon after they disappear into the sand as they do not have enough water to reach the sea.
- ▶ Luni is the only large river in this region.
- ▶ Barchans (crescent-shaped dunes) cover larger areas.
- ▶ But longitudinal dunes become more prominent near the Indo-Pakistan boundary.
- ▶ If you visit Jaisalmer, you may go to see a group of barchans.

* The Coastal Plains

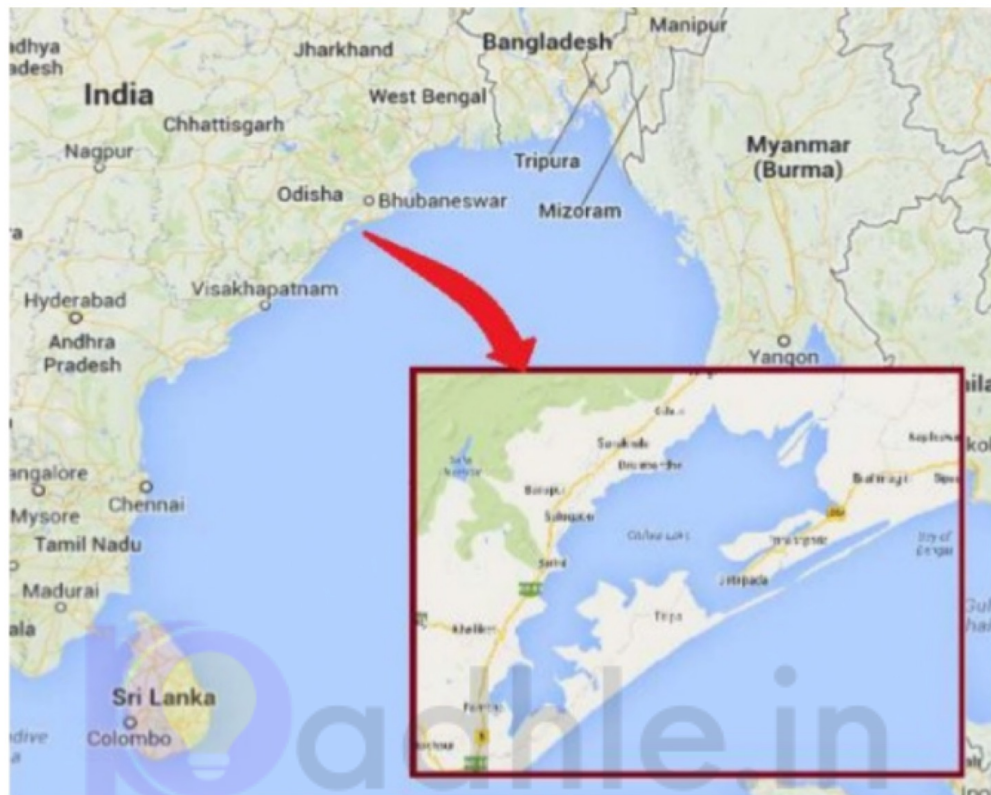
- ▶ The Peninsular Plateau is flanked by a stretch of narrow coastal strips, running along the Arabian Sea on the west and the Bay of Bengal on the east.
- ▶ The western coast, sandwiched between the Western Ghats and the Arabian Sea, is a narrow plain.

- ▷ It consists of three sections.
- ▷ The northern part of the coast is called the Konkan (Mumbai-Goa).
- ▷ The central stretch is called the Kannad Plain
- ▷ The southern stretch is referred to as the Malabar coast.

Eastern Coastal Plains	Western Coastal Plains
Eastern Coastal Plain is divided into 2 stretches North and South. The part which is in the South is known as Coromandel Coast and the Northern Stretch of Eastern Coastal Plains is known as Northern Circar.	Western Coastal Plains are divided into 3 different sections. The southern part is known as Malabar Coast, the Central part of the Western Coast is known as the Karavali or Kanara. The Northern Part of the Western Coast is known as Konkan.
Eastern Coastal Plain is in between the Bay of Bengal in the East and the Eastern Ghats to its West.	Western Coastal Plain is between the Arabian Sea and the Western Ghats.
Wide Deltas are formed by large rivers on the Eastern Coastal Plains	No Deltas are formed in Western Coastal plains, by small rivers.
Eastern Coastal Plain is fertile due to alluvial soil	Except for the Southern Part i.e. Malabar Coast, the Western Coastal Plain is infertile for agricultural purposes.
Eastern Coastal Plain is broader	Western Coastal Plains are very narrow
Eastern Coastal plain is a level surface	Western Coastal plain is intersected by mountain ridges.

- ▷ Large rivers, such as the Mahanadi, the Godavari, the Krishna and the Kaveri have formed extensive delta on the eastern coast.
- ▷ Lake Chilka is an important feature along the eastern coast.

- It is the largest saltwater lake in India.
- It lies in the state of Odisha, to the south of the Mahanadi delta.



* The Island



* Corals

- Coral polypes are short-lived microscopic organisms, which live in colonies.
- ▶ They flourish in shallow, mud-free and warm waters.
- ▶ They secrete calcium carbonate.

* Lakshwadeep Islands

- Group lying close to the Malabar coast in Kerala.
- It is composed of small Coral islands.
- Earlier they were known as Laccadive, Minicoy and Amindivi (Renamed in 1973)
- It covers small area of 32 sq.km.
- Administrative headquarter of these islands is Kavaratti.

* Andaman and Nicobar Islands

- Elongated chain of islands in the Bay of Bengal.

- The entire group is divided into two broad categories.
 - ① Andaman in the North
 - ② Nicobar in the South
- It is believed that these islands are an elevated portion of submarine mountains.
- There is a great diversity of flora and fauna in this group of islands too.
- These islands lie close to the equator and experience an equatorial climate and has thick forest cover.



India's only active volcano is found on Barren island in Andaman and Nicobar group of Islands.

- Each region in India complements the other and makes the country richer in its natural resources.
 - The mountains are the major sources of water and forest wealth.
 - The northern plains are the granaries of the country.
 - They provide the base for early civilisations.
 - The plateau is a storehouse of minerals, which has played a crucial role in the industrialisation of the country.
 - The coastal region and island group provide sites for fishing and port activities.
- * Thus, the diverse physical features of the land have immense future possibilities of development.